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Can the princess of the moon wish upon a star?

by Bagge

Summary

A teenage Glimmer in a nightly conversation with the moonstone

Notes

Warning: Mild acrophobia (falling/jumping from high places) and puberty related trans angst

“Hi, me again. No big deal, you know, just the princess of the moon. No, no, don’t get up. I’ll sit.” Princess Glimmer plonked down on the pedestal, in front of the glowing moonstone that overlooked the castle. The night sky was dark, with just of the few moons up, all of them paling compared to the magical runestone they connected to.

“So, what’s been going on for you lately? Lot of mooning? Lot of stoning? Wow, sure sounds busy.” Glimmer heaved her legs over the edge, casually swinging them back and forth over the enormous drop.

“Me? Why, thanks for asking. Me and Bow went on that Whispering Woods expedition I told you about. We found some cool ruins that Bow's convinced are from the First Ones, but mom says it's actually an old trading post. Shows what she knows. Just because she was there a million years ago or whenever.” Glimmer scoffed.

“Otherwise, everything is boring as usual. Mom is still a scaredy-cat, Casta hides in Mystacor after her and mom's latest row. Dad is still dead and no one does anything about the Horde.” She brightened up. “I’m still a princess though, so that’s something. The potions work really well.” She tentatively squeezed at her chest. “I think I’m starting to get boobs. Bow says he doesn’t see any difference, but it's not like he's a girl any more or anything so what would he know?”

She frowned. “His potions are working too. He says his family is supportive about him not being a girl, but he gets really cagey every time he talks about them, so I’m not so sure...” She clenched her fists, causing pink sparks to fly. “They better be supportive, or I’ll have something to say about it.”

After a moment, she opened her hand, dejectedly. The light died out. “...if I can be trusted to do even that, of course. ‘Oh no, poor little weak princess! Lock her up so she’ll be safe from the big, mean, world.’” She clenched both fists, her entire body radiating

of pink light for a moment. Then she relaxed and it died out. She glared at the moonstone, her every pore drinking in the magic.

"Is that why I'm so weak? Because I was born in the wrong body? Am I not enough of a princess for you? Well, tough shit. I AM a princess, no matter what some stupid rock has to say about it."

She glared at the moonstone for a little while, but then she dejectedly looked down at the ground.

"Sorry, that's unfair of me. I know that's not it. Mom says that a prince can be magical, just as a princess. Just look at prince Peekablue." She wiggled with her fingers. "Oooooh! I'm so mysterious and knowledgeable because of my faaaaaaarsight that I will never use to tell anyone anything useful ever even if it could SAVE SOMEONE'S DADDY'S LIFE!"

She closed her eyes and allowed her breathing to calm down before she opened them again. The moonstone just glowed, like it always did.

"Also, it's not like Perfuma isn't a full magical princess, and she was born as a boy too. Remember when me and mom visited Plumeria last year? She could to all sorts of cool things. She made an entire tree bloom, just like that. She even had a living treehouse. A LIVING TREEHOUSE! And what can I do? Poof. Sparkle. That's it. And then I have to recharge. Lame."

She gave the moonstone a pleading look. "It's not the 'princess' part that's wrong, is it? It's me. It has to be me. Because I'm... weak."

She blinked out a tear. "Why do I have to be the weak princess?"

The moonstone kept glowing. Glimmer shouted at it. "WHY? Am I not good enough for you, is THAT it? Is is something I have to figure out? Is it something 'I'll get when I'm older'? Am I just that much a piece of trash? Good-for-nothing-stupid Glimmer. Can't protect her people. Can't avenge her dad. Can't do ANYTHING

except sit and be protected like a stupid PET while people DIE for her?”

She smashed her fist at the shining rock. Ripples spread through it, like she had been shaking a snow globe.

“Well, fuck that shit. I’m NOT staying in my cage. I’m fighting the Horde whatever mom has to say, and if I have to face them with a spark and a poof, than THAT’S WHAT I’LL DO!” She snarled at the stone, daring it to speak up against her. But of course it didn’t.

“I’m selfish,” she muttered, her rage switching to self loathing in just a heartbeat. “Most people don’t have any magic, and I - a magical princess - whine about having too little. Bow's ready to fight the Horde with just a bow and arrow, and I’m pouty because I can’t fly. Or shoot lighting bolts. Or control plants. Or turn into a mermaid (like SOME princesses) or ANYTHING EXCEPT SPARK AND POOF, and even then I have to recharge.” She took a deep breath. “So yes, add that to my big list of useless traits. I’m weak. I need to be protected. And I’m selfish. Fine. I’ll admit it. I’ll STILL fight the Horde. I’ll fight them with a toy sword if I have to.”

Glimmer glared at the moonstone again, to the usual lack of response. Then she abruptly started to snicker. “Actually, I don’t have to use a toy sword. Don’t tell mom, but I managed to sneak off with a battle axe from the armoury. I’ve hidden it in one of the old storage rooms. I bet I can sneak off with a lot more weapons without them catching on.” She winked at the rock. “I’ll even get a bow for Bow. A real bow, like the soldiers use. But I think he’ll still want to make his own arrows. That stupid net-arrow he’s been tinkering with actually seems to work now.”

She licked her lips. “Can I tell you a secret? Sometimes... sometimes I worry that he will figure out what a wreck I am and find someone cooler to hang out with. Like, I know he thinks it’s cool that I’m a princess and all but... I’m ME. I’m a disaster. He’ll... go to Salineas or something. Mermista is a pirate! So much more cool than a weirdo-weak-sparkle-princess.”

For a moment she hugged herself in silence, then she shuddered and abruptly stood up and stared at her reflection in the moonstone. “No, that’s quitter’s talk. I’m Glimmer of Brightmoon. I’m an Elemental Princess of Etheria. I’m amazing. I’m a kickass badass who everyone want to be friends with. I’m not a little weirdo-no-friends-weak-princess. Me and Bow will be best of friends forever. I’m Glimmer and I ROCK!” She held up her fist in the air and gave the moonstone a little nod. “And you rock, too I suppose,” she generously added. “Since you are a rock, and all.”

She stepped up to the very edge of the platform and looked down, swaying precariously back and forth. “I rock...” she silently repeated to herself. She glanced over her shoulder, at the moonstone. “Hey, can I tell you another secret? But this one is a SECRET secret. This one you’ll have to be absolutely quiet about. OK? OK.” She took a deep breath. “In a few years... next time princess prom comes around, I’m asking Bow. That’s right! I said it. I’m asking Bow to come to princess prom with me. Him and me, as best friends in matching outfits and with inside jokes having the best night ever!” She touched the side of a neck, which was suddenly a lot warmer than before. “...the best night ever...” She closed her eyes, took a shivering breath and, without further ado, fell off the platform.

For a few exhilarating moments she picked up momentum, her long trailing over her like the tail of a comet as she rushed towards the ground, then she disappeared in a cloud of pink sparks and reappeared back on the platform, proudly holding her hands on her hips. “Cool, huh? Remember the first time I tried that? Mom almost went into hysterics!” She went to the side and looked down. “I’m getting MUCH better at poofing on short notice. Do you think I have enough juice for another go?” She held up her hand and critically eyed the sparks that emerged. She gave the moonstone a scornful look. “Fiiiine, scaredy-cat. I’ll gas up first.” She put both palms on the smooth surface of the moonstone, and for a short moment etchings like the alphabet of the first ones glowed in her skin. She contently watched the resulting sparks. “Much better.”

She jumped from the pedestal and poofed back up three more times, recharging between each jump. Slightly out of breath, but happy, she plonked down on the pedestal again with her back to the moonstone. She looked up towards the sky.

"Hey, you're old, right? Mom says you were there at the time of the first ones. You know, when there were still stars in the sky? I asked mom what they looked like, and she got all mushy and told me to look in a mirror."

Glimmer giggled. "Yeah, I know. Typical corny mom stuff, right? But honestly... it was a bit cute. Anyway, turns out she meant the spots in my hair." She held up a strand of pink hair and looked at the it quizzically. Little specks of lights twinkled between her fingers.

"So, I guess this is what it looks like. Just tiny little moons. I asked mom what the big deal was, and she got all mommy and started to talk about the legends of a larger universe, and how every star was its own world and how the First Ones came from another star far, far away and blah, blah, blah. I dunno... Seems a bit far fetched to me." She frowned. "Although there are those who say that's where Hordak comes from... from the stars." She let go of her hair and summoned a bright pink flash. "If that's so, then I'll send him packing, right back. He can have his stupid stars, but he'll leave our world alone."

She picked up the strand of hair again and held it up towards the sky. "It would look pretty strange, right? The entire sky full of little dots. Bow says he thinks it would look pretty, but he says the same thing about my hair, so I dunno."

"Hey, did you know that back in the ancient times, people used to make a wish, when they saw a star? It's something Bow's dads told him. He says that's how he knew the spots in my hair are stars, because I'm his wish coming true." She smiled fondly. "Dork. I swear, he can be just as corny as mom. It was nice of him to say, though."

Glimmer frowned. "How does that even work? Mom says there were billions of stars in the sky. Did you get one wish for each star, or did you have to pick one? Did everyone get their own star or did they share? I swear, this is exactly why history books are useless. They never tell you the important stuff. Just like moms."

"Like, if I had one wish per star, wouldn't I have bazillions of wishes? I've got tons of stars in my hair." She leaned back, finding a more comfortable position.

"I could wish for everything I wanted..." Her smile grew wistful. "I could wish for dad back. I could wish for mom not to have to worry about everything all the time. I could wish for Bow to meet real pirates, and maybe that princess from Dryl he's always going on about." She blinked. "I could wish to be strong enough to fight the Horde. Maybe do real magic, like dad could. I could wish to be queen, so I could win the war. To defeat Hordak. Maybe even to get us back to the stars, if they are so great. I could wish to have friends. I could wish that all the princesses would want to be friends with me. I could wish to meet someone... someone like me. Someone who really gets what its like, when no one thinks you're good for anything... And throw in a flying pony and a magical kitty," she added as a sarcastic afterthought.

She sat in silence for a long while, looking towards the sky without really seeing it.

"That would be nice," she said in low voice. "But that's not how it works, is it? Dad is dead. Mom will never let me fight for real and I will never stop being weak and useless."

She growled and jumped to her feet. "No! That sucks. I'm NOT weak. I'm NOT useless. And if we can't just wish the Horde away, then we'll defeat them without the stars. Who cares about stupid stars anyway? What did they ever do for us?" She pressed her hands against the moonstone again. The magic flowed into her.

"Thanks for listening to me, but I better get back to my room. Don't tell mom, but me and Bow are totally sneaking out again

tomorrow to check out those ruins. Who knows, maybe we'll find some cool First One's tech for Bow that will help us against the Horde."

Glimmer stepped up to the edge of the platform again, but hesitated and glanced back at the moonstone when a new thought struck her. "Hey, do you think I should cut my hair? I bet princess Mermista would want to be friends with a badass shorthaired-princess." She grinned. "I bet mom would hate it. Anyway, talk to you later."

And with a last sparkle, the princess jumped off the platform and teleported away.

Only the moonstone remained, shining cold and bright, like always.

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